

Βοηθὸς ὁ Σιδώνιος

Nature and Fate in the Peripatetic Fragments of Boethus of Sidon

eul_aid: naw

Period: Ἑλληνιστική Hellenistic
Dialect: Κοινή φιλοσοφική Philosophical Koine
Domain: Φιλοσοφία Philosophy
Format: Συναγωγή Collection
Affiliation: Peripatetic

Boethus of Sidon was a philosopher of the Peripatetic school, active in the 1st century BCE. He was a student of Andronicus of Rhodes, the scholar responsible for organizing Aristotle's works. This places Boethus in a pivotal period when Aristotle's philosophy was being revived and systematically studied. He should not be confused with an earlier Stoic philosopher who shared the same name and hometown.

None of Boethus's own writings survive intact. His philosophical ideas are known only through fragments and discussions recorded by later commentators, such as Alexander of Aphrodisias. According to these sources, Boethus was a critical and engaged interpreter of Aristotle. He is particularly noted for his debates on core Aristotelian concepts, including the system of categories, the nature of substance, and the problem of universals. For example, he famously disagreed with Aristotle's definition of "place," arguing for a more materialist explanation.

Modern scholars see Boethus as a significant figure in the early reception of Aristotle. The fact that leading later philosophers felt the need to address and refute his arguments indicates that his interpretations were considered important within the Peripatetic tradition. His work exemplifies the lively scholarly debates that shaped Hellenistic philosophy after Aristotle's texts were rediscovered and edited.

Works (1)

- Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ Φύσεως καὶ Εἰμαρμένης · Fragments on Nature and Fate · 11 passages

Other Peripatetic Authors

- Ἀγαθαρχίδης ὁ Κνίδιος · Agatharchides of Cnidus · 4 works
- Ἀλέξανδρος ὁ Ἀφροδισιεύς · Alexander of Aphrodisias II · 2 works
- Ἀνδρόνικος ὁ Ρόδιος · Andronicus of Rhodes · 2 works
- Ἀρίστων ὁ Κεῖος · Aristo of Ceos · 1 work
- Ἀριστόβουλος ὁ Ἰουδαῖος · Aristobulus the Jewish Philosopher · 1 work
- Ἀριστοκλῆς ὁ Μεσσηνίος · Aristocles of Messene · 1 work
- Ἀριστόμβροτος ὁ φιλόσοφος · Aristombrotus the Philosopher · 1 work
- Ἀρίστων ὁ Κεῖος · Ariston of Ceos · 1 work

- Ἀσπάσιος ὁ Περιπατητικός · [Aspasius the Peripatetic](#) · 1 work
- Χαμαιλέων ὁ Ἡρακλεώτης · [Chamaeleon of Heraclea Pontica](#) · 2 works
- Κλέαρχος ὁ Σολεύς · [Clearchus of Soli](#) · 1 work
- Κριτόλαος ὁ Φασηλίτης · [Critolaus of Phaselis philosopher](#) · 1 work